

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner, OOH Platform & Locker.OS.*

Positioning, ten years owning backlogs in regulated, hardware-adjacent B2B environments, bringing the same structured delivery discipline to GLS/NXT's parcel-locker platform. ≤ 25 words.

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§ WHY GLS/NXT

GLS/NXT sits in an interesting position: startup velocity backed by a pan-European logistics network, building standardized software that runs physical infrastructure at scale. What draws me specifically to Locker.OS is that the challenge is not purely digital, you are shipping a software stack that must behave correctly when the hardware is offline, the user is standing in the rain, and the support team is fielding tickets in three languages. That kind of constraint forces rigorous requirements work, not wishful thinking. My background spans hardware-integrated products (quantum-secure encryption at Qcrypt AG) and operationally complex platforms (FCAS data infrastructure, national labour-market analytics), environments where ambiguity costs real money and "we'll figure it out in sprint" is not an option. *That is exactly the environment where disciplined backlog ownership compounds.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec generation and edge-case drafting
- **Cursor / VSCode**, AI-assisted requirements and documentation
- **GitHub Copilot**, code-adjacent feature scoping
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for user story validation
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder presentation and roadmap communication
- **GPT**, discovery synthesis and user interview analysis

- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation across tooling
 - **Framer**, clickable prototype walkthroughs
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

REST APIs, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps rollout and rollback, CI/CD via Jenkins and GitLab, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, Azure DevOps, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, Matomo.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, built solo from zero.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protecting both sides until commitment is confirmed.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, reducing onboarding friction to near zero.
 - LLM agents across the funnel so one operator runs the full day-to-day without headcount.
 - Demonstrates the zero-to-one, low-overhead platform thinking directly applicable to an OOH ecosystem with many hardware partners and limited engineering bandwidth.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT GLS/NXT

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow support tickets, read existing Confluence documentation for Locker.OS, and sit with engineering to understand where the backlog is unclear, where acceptance criteria are missing, and where recurring escalations signal underspecified requirements.

WEEK 2

Triage and sharpen.

Run a structured backlog audit against the pillar roadmap, assign rough business-value and effort scores, surface the top ambiguities to stakeholders, and produce a refined, ready-for-sprint queue with written acceptance criteria for the highest-priority items.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Lead the first sprint planning session, establish the cadence of refinement and review rituals, and begin routing recurring support patterns back into discovery, so the backlog reflects real locker-operator pain, not assumptions.

I COVER LETTER

Dear GLS/NXT team,

I am applying for the Product Owner role for the Locker.OS pillar. The role combines two things I find genuinely interesting: the operational complexity of running software on physical infrastructure at international scale, and the backlog discipline required to keep an engineering team unblocked when the product is still being defined. I have spent ten years doing exactly that, in environments where the cost of ambiguity shows up as a missed sprint, a broken integration, or a client who loses trust.

My most directly relevant experience is at Qcrypt AG, where I owned a product that combined custom hardware with a multi-layer software stack, shipping a three-minute installation path for enterprise buyers who would not tolerate longer. The challenge there was not technical, it was requirements: writing acceptance criteria tight enough that hardware and software behaved predictably together, and translating security constraints (quantum-resistant OTP encryption) into user stories an embedded engineer could act on. That is the same muscle Locker.OS needs: clear, hardware-aware requirements, and a backlog that reflects both the software behaviour and the physical deployment context.

At Rohde & Schwarz, I managed a cross-functional team of fifteen engineers and data scientists on the FCAS AI and data platform, running Scrum in Jira and Confluence across multinational teams. I redirected strategy mid-cycle based on instrumented workflow analysis, two competing designs, one recorded zero clicks, and delivered a GitOps rollout that cut deployment time from days to thirty minutes. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit, I carried a full ETL migration, a UI relaunch, and a bare-metal-to-container migration through the same period without slipping delivery. These are not separate achievements; they reflect how I work: keeping engineering moving while absorbing strategic changes, and using data to justify the trade-offs.

The Locker.OS scope, a standardized software stack for GLS parcel lockers, serving international markets and a partner ecosystem, is a B2B platform problem at the infrastructure layer. My logistics specialisation from TU Berlin and my B2B SaaS experience at EMIL Group (insurance platform for insurers, reinsurers and brokers) give me the domain framing to speak sensibly with business stakeholders, while my technical fluency with APIs, containerized environments, and CI/CD pipelines means I can have a real conversation with engineering rather than relaying messages. I also bring comfort with AI tooling as a daily productivity lever, not a talking point, I use Claude Code, Copilot and Lovable routinely to draft specs, generate edge cases, and prototype quickly.

I am based in Berlin, hold EU citizenship, and can start within four weeks of an offer. I would welcome a conversation about the Locker.OS roadmap and where the pillar is today.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Owner and product manager with 13 years of backlog ownership across B2B SaaS, hardware-integrated products, public-sector platforms, and regulated industries. I translate strategic priorities into clear, ready-for-sprint backlogs, lead Scrum rituals end to end, and keep cross-functional teams unblocked through structured requirements work and transparent trade-off communication. My logistics specialisation (TU Berlin) and direct experience shipping hardware-software products make me a close fit for an OOH platform role where physical and digital constraints are inseparable.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Ownership: user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, sprint review, retrospective, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, WIP limits, SAFe, ART, PI planning.

Platform and API Fluency: REST APIs, system architecture, containerised environments, CI/CD, GitOps with ArgoCD, Kubernetes, Docker, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Git.

Analytics and Data: KPI definition, funnel and churn analysis, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Governance: GDPR/DSGVO, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI PLATFORM 2024-2025

Cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists; Scrum in Jira and Confluence. GitOps rollout via ArgoCD cut deployment time from days to 30 minutes; developer-first strategy increased pipeline runs 200%.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

National labour-market platform; Deputy IT Security Officer. Introduced Dagster and dbt, cutting data-update effort by 75%; delivered full bare-metal-to-container migration and UI relaunch in parallel.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Backlog triage cut scope to top 10% of features; user acceptance rose fivefold. Shipped CGM/KIS integration reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · B2B SAAS INSURANCE PLATFORM 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery org into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center concept-to-production; cut new-product launch time from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL POS & PAYMENTS 2021-2022

Moved research into production across a matrix organisation in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · SECURE GOVERNMENT DATA PLATFORM 2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · B2B PROCUREMENT WEBSHOP 2019-2020

Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production. Backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · FULL SITE IT MODERNISATION 2019

Wind energy; end-to-end site IT modernisation in Wismar and Magdeburg.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK INFRASTRUCTURE 2017-2018

Wi-Fi rollout across nine hospitals; healthcare B2B stakeholder alignment.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · B2B CONSTRUCTION MARKETPLACE 2025-PRESENT

Zero to one solo: two-sided staffing marketplace with anonymity-until-payment, WhatsApp/Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Hardware-software integrated product; shipped three-minute enterprise installation path. Later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · AGRITECH 2018-2021

Nanotechnology fertiliser from lab to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Mobile group-based P2P payment product; built from zero, acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native (C2). English, C2, business and technical fluency.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · GLS/NXT

